Chris Dorward

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Open Source GitHub Repo (NX°): github.com/goldlabelapps/nx

Senior Frontend & Fullstack Developer

Accomplished Frontend Developer with 20+ years of deep expertise in JavaScript, React, TypeScript, and modern UI engineering, currently specializing in Next.js. Over two decades delivering polished, high-performance web applications across the UK, Europe, Australia, and beyond, I have continuously expanded my craft into full-stack architecture—incorporating Python and Node.js backend development, serverless APIs, cloud infrastructure, and AI/Agentic coding workflows. My strong foundation in user interfaces, design systems, and client-side performance directly informs how I design and build end-to-end full-stack systems and AI-integrated applications.

Technical Skills

- **Frontend & UI Engineering (Core Specialty):** React, Next.js (App Router), TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), React Native, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Material UI, CSS / Styled Components, Progressive Web Apps (PWA), Data Visualization (D3.js, Chart.js, Recharts), Figma
- **Fullstack & Backend Development (Expanded Capabilities):** Node.js, Python (FastAPI), Express, REST APIs, GraphQL, Serverless architectures, API design and integration, PHP (WordPress, Drupal, Magento, MVC architectures, Composer)
- **Databases & Cloud Infrastructure:** Firebase / Firestore, Supabase, DynamoDB, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL, NoSQL, AWS (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3, ECS), Vercel, Netlify, Render, Docker
- **AI & Agentic Development:** Agentic Coding, AI-assisted software development, LLM integration, prompt engineering, OpenAI & AI APIs, Google Antigravity, local LLM integration (Ollama, phi-3)
- **Testing, Quality & Workflows:** Jest, React Testing Library, Automated Testing, BDD, Gherkin, Git / GitHub / GitLab, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Turborepo, Webpack, Agile / Scrum, Jira, Confluence

Professional Experience

Principal Engineer — askleida.com

May 2026 – Aug 2026

End-to-end engineering for Leida MVP, an AI-powered platform helping solo skin therapists generate personalized homecare recommendations in minutes.

- Led product delivery and frontend architecture using Next.js and TypeScript, building responsive, AI-assisted recommendation workflows.
- Expanded into full-stack delivery by developing secure server-side APIs backed by Supabase and integrated Stripe checkout and webhooks.
- Focused on performance, UI responsiveness, and release quality across the entire stack.

Fullstack Developer (Next.js & Python) — EchoPay

Contract — Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Built frontend interface on custom NX Next.js platform, decoupled from backend services, prioritizing fast, seamless user interactions.
- Developed Python (FastAPI) backend services for a B2B ordering platform, handling CSV product management, real-time order updates, and secure payment flows.
- Designed and deployed secure APIs for orders, customer history, and admin dashboards, hosting operations on Render.com.

Independent Software Developer — Freelance & R&D

Remote — May 2025 – Dec 2025

Operating as an independent developer across paid freelance work, open-source product development, and deep technical upskilling, bridging frontend engineering with full-stack and AI capabilities.

- Delivered client projects applying high production standards across UI code quality, accessibility, and maintainability.
- Built and evolved Goldlabel, an open-source Next.js frontend platform serving as a testbed for modern architecture and tooling.
- Researched AI-assisted software delivery, integrating local LLMs (Ollama) with Python tools into Next.js workflows to accelerate end-to-end feature development.

Frontend Developer — VU.CITY

London / Hybrid — Apr 2024 – May 2025

- Led the development of internal tools and the Admin Portal using Next.js (App Router), Firebase Auth, and Firestore.
- Architected a modular frontend platform to power multiple apps with a shared design system based on MUI.
- Built event-driven user interfaces that integrate with external systems, including AWS and internal APIs.
- Championed best practices across accessibility, performance, and developer experience.

Full Stack JavaScript Developer — Dtrackt!

Malta — Jun 2021 - Feb 2024

- Delivered high-performance static and PWA frontend sites using Gatsby (Node + React) in a lean, cross-functional team.
- Integrated Headless CMS platforms (Contentful, Strapi) and implemented Material UI Design Systems for consistent UX.
- Expanded full-stack responsibilities while facilitating agile delivery as Scrum Master.

Product Lead — Wanngi

Brisbane, Australia — Jun 2020 - Nov 2020

- Led the frontend redevelopment of a legacy Angular PWA into a modern React-based platform connected with Supabase.
- Architected core framework features using custom open-source tooling and guided a small engineering team.

Senior Frontend Developer — Codeworx

Brisbane, Australia — Sep 2019 - Feb 2020

- Migrated a legacy poker app from CoffeeScript/jQuery to a modern React-based PWA and React Native App.
- Refactored critical UI flows to improve maintainability, speed, and overall user experience.

Senior Frontend Developer — Rexlabs

Brisbane, Australia — Mar 2019 - Aug 2019

- Supported transition from legacy PHP/Knockout stack to a React/Redux frontend.
- Modularized UI components and mentored junior developers during frontend migration sprints.

React Developer — Boral

Contract — Sydney, Australia — Aug 2018 - Feb 2019

- Developed and tested multiple React PWAs with AWS Amplify and GraphQL.
- Built foundational test architecture using Cucumber, Gherkin, and BDD principles to support rapid CI/CD deployment.

Senior Frontend Developer — Canon Australia

Contract — Sydney, Australia — Mar 2018 - Aug 2018

- Led frontend development of a full-featured Progressive Web App from scratch.
- Architected state management with Redux and persistent store, integrating SaaS APIs for rich user interactions.

Frontend Engineer — Aligent Consulting

Adelaide, Australia — Apr 2017 - Mar 2018

- Developed responsive frontend themes and custom JavaScript (ES6) modules for high-traffic Magento e-commerce sites.
- Built commercial-grade Progressive Web Apps (PWAs) in React for mobile-first performance and checkout optimization.

Fullstack Developer — ustwo

Contract — Sydney, Australia — Jan 2017 - Feb 2017

- Lead developer for Cancer Council NSW's Healthy Lunchbox app, building a React frontend connected to a WordPress REST API.
- Developed custom PHP endpoints and WordPress plugins to bridge frontend requirements with CMS backends.

Frontend Software Engineer — Alcidion

Adelaide, Australia — Aug 2016 - Nov 2016

- Built real-time UI interfaces for a hospital bed management system using React and Redux within an agile SCRUM team.

Contract JavaScript Developer — Huawei

Shenzhen, China — Feb 2016 - May 2016

- Built an isomorphic JavaScript project management app using React and Node.js.

Contract JavaScript Developer — The Changing Workplace

London — Sep 2015 - Jan 2016

- Developed frontend JavaScript applications handling complex, high-volume datasets for enterprise SaaS platforms.

Self-Employed Web Developer — Listingslab

Remote / Global — Jul 2007 - Jul 2015

- Delivered full-stack web development, specializing in frontend UIs (HTML5, CSS3, jQuery) alongside custom WordPress PHP multisite solutions.

Senior Developer — Velo//

London — Oct 2010 - Dec 2011

- Developed frontend and backend features using Flash and PHP/MySQL for multi-client campaigns.

Lead Product Developer — FMG

London — Nov 2005 - Dec 2006

- Designed and launched Ceros, a Flash-based digital publishing platform, developing the frontend interactive prototype and backend integrations.

Senior Systems Developer — IG Index

London — Oct 2003 - Nov 2005

- Lead Flash developer producing interactive digital campaigns and partner interfaces.

Early Career Summary

(1999–2004)

Held a series of Flash and web development roles during the peak of the web/Flash era, building rich interactive client interfaces and early web applications.

- **Highlights:** Cantor Fitzgerald (2002–2003), Eurobet (2002), Pearson Broadband (2002–2003), Kyunet Sydney (2001–2002), KPE London (2000–2001), 4MAT / Aspinalls (1999).

Education & Qualifications

- **BSc Psychology** — Newcastle University, UK (1999)
- **A Levels:** Maths, Physics, Chemistry — Woodbridge School, Suffolk (1994)
- **GCSEs:** 10 Subjects including English, Maths, and Science

Languages

- **English:** Native

- **German:** Fluent — bilingual upbringing, partial schooling in Germany
- **French:** Conversational

Work Eligibility

- UK & German passports, full work eligibility in UK and EU

Recommendations

Yui Andoh, *Software Engineer (November 2020)*

"Chris quickly understood business needs and identified technical problems soon after joining the team. His approach for tackling core issues was innovative and well-designed, and his solution made it so much easier for developers to maintain the app, and also for users to have better experiences using it. Not only is he a highly skilled full-stack developer, but also a reliable instructor/team leader that led the team with lots of support. The experience of working with him was full of wit and mind-blowing learning."